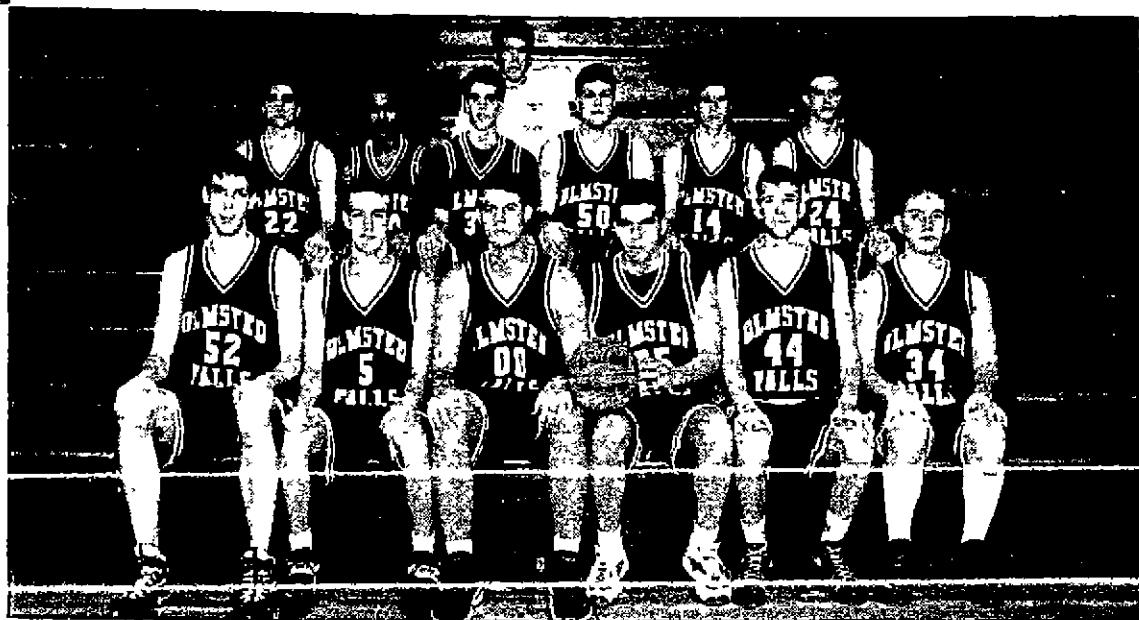




OLMSTED FALLS BOYS: Front row, from left, Jim Kalemba, John Storey, Tim Schaefer, Dan Peterite, Chris Flood, Josh Schneider; back row, from left, Rob Suzech, Mancie Williams, Sean Radigan, Jeff Miller, Keith Knapp, Chris Rybicki. At top is manager Clyde Mander.



OLMSTED FALLS GIRLS: Front row, from left, Barbara Davis, Angela Serrani, Jessica Hance, Casey Shank, Caryn Humpal, Micala Hicks, head coach Tom Gibeaut; back row, from left, Penny Mikulka, Amber Armstrong, Abby Jaroscak, Marcy Namestnik, Brooke Theis, Gretchen Franz.

SCHEDULE

1996-1997 OLMSTED FALLS

	WE	THEY
NOVEMBER		
29 — Brookside	_____	_____
DECEMBER		
6 — at N Royalton, 7:30p.m.	_____	_____
13 — at Amherst*	_____	_____
20 — Rocky River*	_____	_____
21 — North Olmsted*	_____	_____
27 — Erie Cathedral Prep (Sand Tournament), 8p.m.	_____	_____
28 — Sandusky (Sand Tournament), TBA	_____	_____
JANUARY		
3 — at Avon Lake*	_____	_____
7 — Strongsville	_____	_____
10 — Westlake*	_____	_____
17 — Bay*	_____	_____
24 — at Fairview*	_____	_____
25 — Berea	_____	_____
31 — Amherst*	_____	_____
FEBRUARY		
1 — at Rocky River*	_____	_____
7 — at North Olmsted*	_____	_____
14 — Avon Lake*	_____	_____
15 — at Westlake*	_____	_____
21 — at Bay*	_____	_____

* — denotes SWC conference game

Olmsted Falls boys

COACH: Pat Donahue, 7th year
ASSISTANTS: Rich Storey (junior varsity), Curt Clough (freshmen), Jay Messner (varsity assistant)
1995-96 RECORDS (conference/overall): 14-0, 21-3
RETURNING STARTERS: Tim Schaefer, sr., 6-8, post; John Storey, sr., 6-3, guard
OTHER RETURNING LETTERWINNERS: Dan Peterite, sr., 6-3, fwd; Josh Schneider, sr., 6-1, guard, Jim Kalemba, sr., 6-10, post
RETURNING NON-LETTERWINNERS: Sean Radigan, soph., 6-1, guard; Chris Rybicki, sr., 6-1, guard
UP FROM JV: Rob Szczech, jr., 6-2, fwd; Keith Knapp, jr., 5-10, guard; Chris Flood, sr., 6-4, fwd.
TOP NEWCOMERS: Manzie Williams, fr., 5-11, guard
STRENGTHS: Inside game, leadership at key positions
WEAKNESSES: Inexperience
KEYS TO SUCCESSFUL SEASON: Having young players step to fill varsity roles
COACH'S COMMENT: "I expect us to be competitive in the conference and improves as the season goes on" — Pat Donahue

Olmsted Falls girls

COACH: Tom Gibeaut, 8th year
1995-96 RECORDS (conference/overall): 12-2 SWC; 20-3
RETURNING LETTERWINNERS: Casey Shank, sr., 5-4, Jessica Hance, sr., 5-7; Caryn Humpal, sr., 5-8, Angela Serrani, sr., 5-7; Barb Davis, sr., 5-10, Micala Hicks, sr., 5-8, Brooke Theis, jr., 5-7; Gretchen Franz, jr., 5-4; Abby Jaroscak, jr., 5-7
UP FROM JV: Marcy Namestnik, jr., 5-8; Amber Armstrong, jr., 5-7; Penny Mikulka, jr., 5-2
STRENGTHS: Quickness, pressure defense and depth
WEAKNESSES: Lack of height and new style of play
KEYS TO SUCCESSFUL SEASON: Find three consistent scorers, play aggressive defense and play as a team
COACH'S COMMENT: "If this team has the desire to work hard night-in and night-out, and improve each week, they can surprise some people this season. These kids have more potential than they themselves realize" — Tom Gibeaut

SCHEDULE

1996-1997 OLMSTED FALLS

	WE	THEY
NOVEMBER		
22 — St. Joseph Academy	_____	_____
26 — Midview	_____	_____
30 — at North Royalton	_____	_____
DECEMBER		
4 — at Bay*	_____	_____
7 — at Fairview*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
11 — Amherst*	_____	_____
14 — at Rocky River*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
18 — at North Olmsted*	_____	_____
21 — Avon Lake*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
28 — Strongsville, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
JANUARY		
4 — at Westlake*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
8 — Bay*	_____	_____
11 — Fairview*	_____	_____
18 — at Amherst*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
25 — Rocky River*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
27 — Elyria	_____	_____
29 — Buckeye	_____	_____
FEBRUARY		
1 — North Olmsted*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
8 — at Avon Lake*, 1 p.m.	_____	_____
12 — Westlake*	_____	_____

* — denotes conference game

JV games start 6 p.m., followed by varsity unless otherwise noted



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Iowa women favored to win Big Ten championship

INDIANAPOLIS (AP) — Nell Fortner had no qualms about taking the women's basketball coaching job at Purdue, even under the circumstances of her predecessor's departure.

Lin Dunn led the Boilermakers to the NCAA tournament Final Four in 1994 and to three Big Ten titles but was fired last spring. After that, a number of players transferred to other schools.

"It's kind of exciting in a way, because the possibilities are endless," Fortner said. "There's no expectations on this team, so everything we get we earn, and it's exciting."

"You hate to see that happen to a fellow coach, that they lose their job, but someone had to take the job. It was a good job, and I took it," Fortner said at a meeting of the Big Ten women's coaches.

Purdue was 20-11 last season. Only three letter-winners are back — Stephanie White, Jannon Roland and Ukari Figgs. Five of the newcomers are freshmen, along with senior Corissa Yasen, the NCAA heptathlon champion who hasn't played basketball since high school.

"Losing the players didn't affect us at all. We didn't know them, and if they don't want to be there, then that's their choice. I respect that choice. They need to go where they need to go," said Fortner, a former assistant at Louisiana Tech and an assistant with the gold-medal U.S. Olympic team this year.

Iowa, which returns four starters, is the heavy favorite to repeat as Big Ten champion this season. The Hawkeyes were 27-4 last season, and their only loss in 16 Big Ten games was to Purdue.

"Absolutely. I would think

hands down," Fortner said of Iowa's status as the favorite. "Their talent is unbelievable."

Iowa coach Angie Lee, a former Iowa team captain and assistant coach for six years before taking over the top spot last season, doesn't disagree.

"As far as defense of the championship, I don't think there's any question that we're where we want to be," she said.

"In regards to defending the title, there are some things we've got to do. No. 1, we have to stay injury-free; No. 2, this team has got to play like the veterans they are. We no longer have the mask of being the 'Fabulous Freshmen,' or whatever we were. We are now veterans and we have to play like veterans."

"Lastly, this team has to focus and practice from day to day, and not look ahead. If you get it done

in practice, the rest of it is going to take care of itself," Lee said.

The returning starters are juniors Tiffany Gooden, Tangela Smith and Nadine Demond and sophomore Amy Herrig. Gooden, the leading scorer last season, and Demond will be the keys, Lee said.

"You have to have team leaders on the floor. Just by essence of her position, I think you have to look at Nadine Demond at our point guard position. She's going to be controlling it out there. But I also think Tiffany Gooden, with her experience and what she's meant to this team so far, will be a leader out on the floor."

Penn State was runner-up to Iowa in the Big Ten and won the conference tournament last year, but the Lady Lions lost three starters. The two returning start-

ers are seniors Angie Potthoff, the leading scorer at 18.5 points a game, and Tiffany Longworth.

"After Iowa, I think it's wide open," Indiana coach Jim Izard said.

"Michigan State has five returning starters, Northwestern has four returning starters. I think Indiana can be one of those top three teams in the league. We don't have to go to Iowa — that's definitely an advantage," Izard said.

The Hoosiers have three starters back, led by 6-foot-5 junior Quacy Barnes.

"Right now we have a lot more depth. ... We have more team speed," Izard said. "We feel really positive about this team. This is our best team since I've been there. They're very explosive offensively."

Indiana was 14-13 last year and ninth in the Big Ten at 5-11.

Lee said Iowa's biggest challenge could come from Wisconsin, which was 21-8 and third in the conference at 12-4.

"They have a very veteran squad themselves and one of the best point guards in the country in Keisha Anderson, so I look for them to be very strong," Lee said.

"I don't think you can ever count out Penn State. Michigan State has what it takes. ... I look at Illinois, I think they're ready to make a crack at the top spot."

"I don't count out a lot of other people — Northwestern, Indiana, Ohio State. Those people are there and you have to go into their places and win there if you're going to come away with the title."